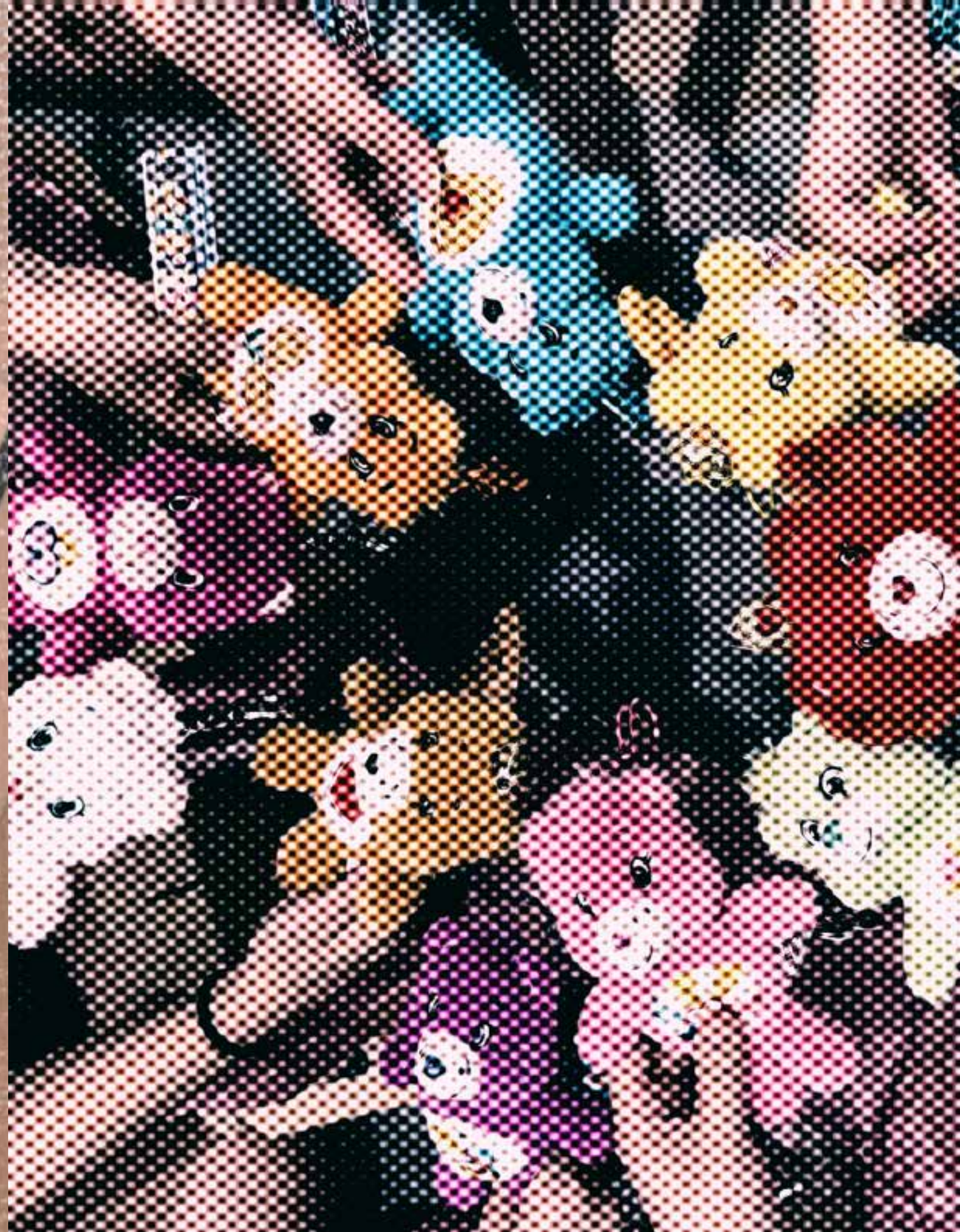

STATUS ACTIVE
BODIES ON STANDBY
GOOD
HOPE
OMG
waiting for input
IDLE


歓迎
Agfa
PHOTO
Enjoy!
写真撮影
FUJICOLOR
SUPER








Capture Your Moment

LOADING...

NO.1

FEATURES

CAPTURING WHAT FEELS REAL
When photos aren’ t prefect, the moments feel more alive.
By: Savannah Sandhaus

14

BACK TO 2000
THE COMEBACK NOBODY SAW COMING
By: Boutayna Chokrane and Christina Perez

22

THE TURN
The tension, the myth, and the reality of Y2K
By: Eric Spitznagel

28

DEPARTMENTS

Live NOW!

REAL TIME
Too Fast to Process
By: Izmayla_ism

10

Live ONLINE!

STATUS
Seen, not known
By: Gabriella Capaldo

12

Live View!

MODE MODE MODE
Framed by the screen
By: Kei Bodkhs

34

Live NOW!

Real Time

Too Fast to Process

By: Izmayla_ism

It started on a casual Friday night. I was scrolling through TikTok, looking for something social to do, when a post about a 2000s-themed shopping bazaar popped up. The catch? A Y2K outfit was optimal. Lucky for me, my mom had just bought me a red Juicy Couture tracksuit when else would I get to wear it? The event was at Chillax Sudirman, easily accessible by MRT. With no Saturday plans, I figured, why not go? Some people might think it's weird to go alone, but who says doing things solo is sad? Maybe social media did. Still, I gave myself a side quest: talk to strangers, ask them about Y2K fashion revival, and maybe make some new friends. Wearing a bright red-faux-fur tracksuit and lugging a duffel bag filled with gym clothes, makeup, and a hairdryer, I felt a bit out of place in the MRT. I wasn't used to dressing this boldly in public. But when I arrived at Setiabudi, I realized I wasn't alone people were decked out in wild, expressive outfits full of color, texture, and sparkle. It felt like stepping into another era. Everyone looked like they came from a collage of early-2000s music videos and childhood dreams. Butterfly clips, low-rise jeans, rhinestone phones it was nostalgic, exciting, and delightfully chaotic. And somehow, for me, it made fashion feel fun again. For the first time in a while, I wasn't thinking about trends or aesthetics I was just happy to be surrounded by people dressing for themselves.Let's start with a surprising origin. Y2K wasn't originally a fashion trend. It referred to a digital panic. As Investopedia explains, the "Y2K bug" was a programming issue that caused fear for global systems that potentially would fail as the year changed from 1999 to 2000. Computers used two-digit dates, so '99' turning into '00' was predicted to crash everything from banking to air travel. The solution? Massive overhaul to four-digit systems, pushed by governments and tech companies in a frantic race against time.

In a way, Gen Z many of whom were still toddlers during that era are nostalgically longing for freedom they never quite got to experience. At the bazaar, surrounded by nostalgic gizmos, handmade accessories, and outfits that looked like visual candy, I realized: this generation doesn't love Y2K fashion because it's trendy. They love it because it reflects a time when fashion was expressive, not prescriptive. As Gen Z revives this era, they're not just chasing nostalgia. They're chasing a time when fashion felt personal, expressive, experimental, and a little rebellious. Maybe it's also a response to today's economic reality in a tight economy, fast fashion leans neutral, minimal, and safe. Not to say that there's anything bad with minimalist fashion, if anything, it combats the hyper-consumerism, hyper-individualism, and hyper-personalized practices of this revival. It all comes down to personal preferences; there's no comparison of which style is better. It comes down to what you want to show yourself. The boldness of Y2K fits with someone who feels comfortable with color and experimentation, for youth who wants to say:

"We don't need rules to be stylish. We'll find joy where we can, and we'll wear it out loud," without the need to scream it. I sum it up as the Y2K revival as an act of celebration of saying: "Wear what you want even if the world feels unstable. Especially then."

Originally published on Medium.com, July 9, 2025



Live ONLINE!

status

SEEN, NOT KNOWN

By: Gabriella Capaldo



From the 2000s until now, teenagers' clothing style has evolved a lot. Some trends have marked certain periods, while others come back into fashion 10 years later, influenced by musical culture or even social media. Let's analyze these important periods, their icons, and their key pieces.

Pink flashy crop top and flared jeans paired with a golden belt and a multitude of bracelets on the forearm, the skirt over pants, the tank top, and cargo pants. All of this reminds us of one period: the 2000s, also called Y2K. Brands like "Juicy Couture," famous for velour and bling-bling, "Von Dutch" for caps and t-shirts with popular logos, or "Guess" and "Miss Sixty" for glamorous jeans. These brands marked the decade by popularizing both minimalism and maximalism. Celebrities like Britney Spears (who popularized low-rise jeans and crop tops thanks to her music videos), Paris Hilton, often associated with Juicy Couture, XXL sunglasses, and baguette bags, and Christina Aguilera, who mixes streetwear and haute couture.

"Fashion is all about fun. If you're not having fun, you're doing it wrong." - Britney Spears

Now, let's talk about the MTV Music Awards: we remember Britney Spears wearing an albino snake that marked pop fashion. Icons of the 2000s, Paris Hilton & Nicole Richie, arrived on the red carpet in Juicy Couture outfits, baguette bags, and XXL sunglasses. A symbol of "bling-bling chic." As for Jennifer Lopez with her green Versace dress (Grammys 2000), it stunned everyone. Glitter, flashy colors (bubblegum pink, neon green, metallic silver), wide belts, etc. This is what the red carpet was made of! Personally, the style of the 2000s fascinates me! I love how people dressed back then: both the flashy colors and the big woolen sweaters! But around the 2010s, all of this would quickly change. These years were characterized by a mix of comfort and style. Skinny jeans paired with slogan hoodies, mom jeans with plaid shirts, ripped pants with plain t-shirts under denim jackets styles were constantly mixed. "Gucci" with maxi logos and retro, "Balenciaga" introducing high-end streetwear, or "Supreme" introducing hype streetwear. Rihanna, Kim Kardashian, Kylie Jenner, and Kanye West are ambassadors of these brands. "Streetwear is the new haute couture."- Kanye West

It's also the impact of social media, so influencers also popularized trends (e.g., luxury sneakers, miniature bags, modernized crop tops, etc). I think the economic crisis pushed fast fashion because it is cheaper and faster, which already attracts many more people. At glamorous events, we can see Rihanna at the 2015 Met Gala in her yellow Guo Pei dress, Kim Kardashian in her tight Balmain looks, or Lady Gaga at the 2019 Oscars in her oversized pink dress. Personally, I really like how luxury and comfort are mixed. But all this would slowly come to an end around 2020 to give way to the great impact of social media. From streetwear to oversized that leans towards cottagecore, through Y2K revival and gorpcore. All styles are allowed! Let's talk about some influential celebrities and their clothing styles! We can see Zendaya with a downtown girl/ modern chic style, Billie Eilish popularizing oversized streetwear/statement looks, and Olivia Rodrigo with a Y2K revival style! These celebrities often wear Gucci, Prada, Shein, ASOS, Depop...

"I never want the world to know everything about me. I mean, that's why I wear big baggy clothes." - Billie Eilish

Parachute pants, floral dresses, or even slicked-back buns. All categorized by different aesthetics such as downtown girl, upscale girl, neat girl... My opinion is that during this period, which is still relevant, people 'sorted out' the different styles with distinct aesthetics on the internet! A kind of organization over the years. Personally, I really like the downtown girl style with the Rory Gilmore sweater and leather bomber vest + Doc Martens, of course, haha! Over the past few years, teenage fashion has shifted from the Y2K 'bling-bling' styles of the 2000s, to the mix of luxury and comfort in the 2010s, and finally to the diverse trends influenced by social media in the 2020s. And you, which style/ period do you prefer?

Originally published on The Teen Magazine.com, September 27, 2025

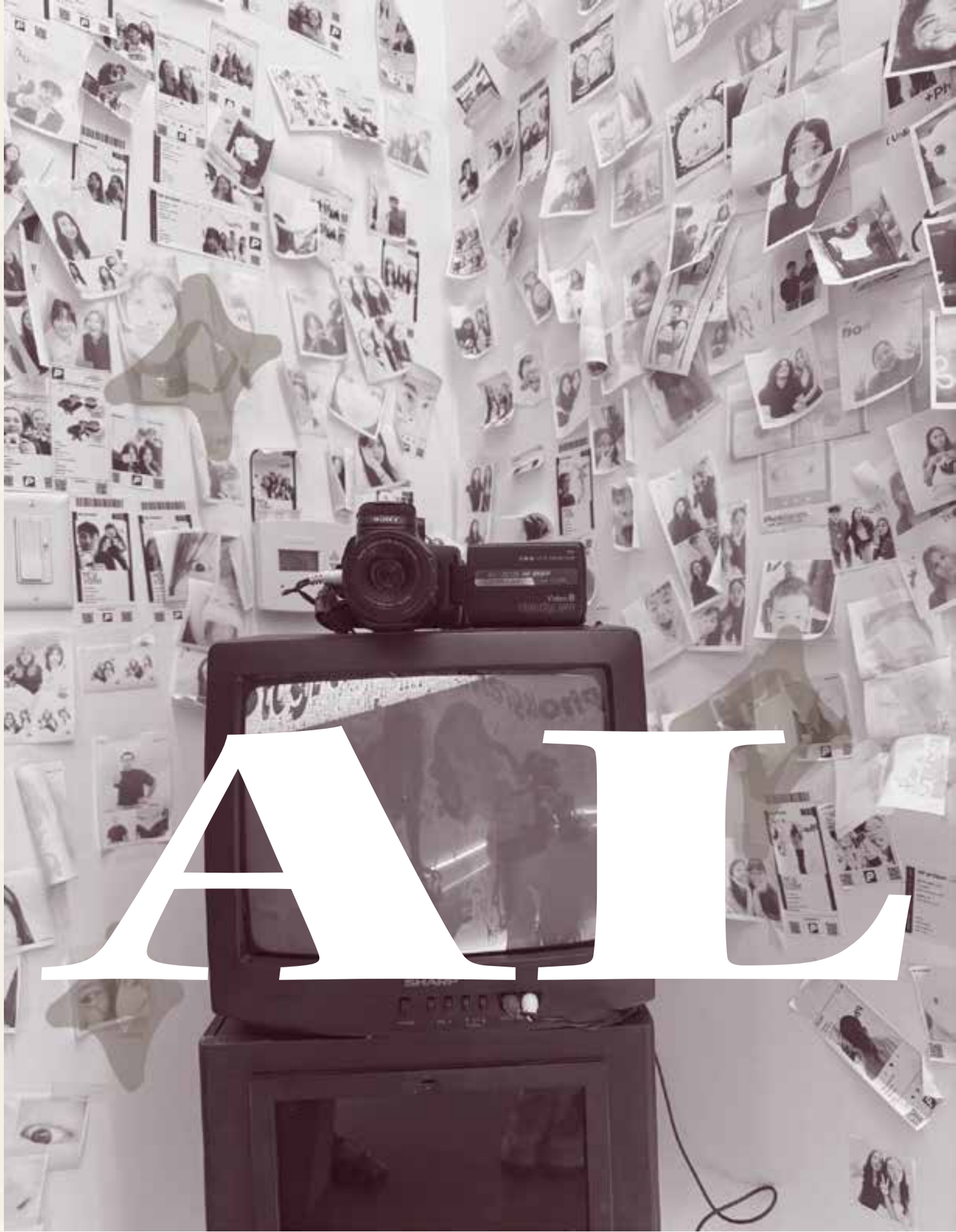


Capturing What Feels

REAL

When photos aren't perfect, the moments feel more alive.

by: Savannah Sandhaus







Since coming to college, I've found myself taking fewer pictures than I did in high school. My camera roll is filled with the same rotation of photos: the gorge frozen over, a sunset taken from the North Star Dining Room balcony and the chalkboard in my PSYCH 2090: Developmental Psychology lecture with notes I can never seem to write down fast enough. Any pictures I take feel more functional now; they hold less weight, less meaning.

Over winter break, my older sister and I decided on a mutual gift secondhand digital cameras from eBay. However, this agreement did make me stop and wonder: Why buy a camera when you already have one in your pocket? In a time shaped by social media fatigue when every photo can be edited, filtered and instantly shared there seems to be a quiet return to something older: the grainy, slightly out-of-focus photos taken on early digital cameras. I remember flipping through printed photographs of my mother in her early 20s, meticulously placed into physical albums. I realized this kind of nostalgic aura feels unattainable through a mobile lens. The grain, the softness in low light and the slight blur of movement made each snapshot feel tethered to a broader moment in time. They lacked fine detail, but in that absence, there was something worth holding onto something that made each moment feel deserving of being remembered. That imperfection made the photos feel more real, less performative. Free from the harsh clarity of modern cameras which push us to scrutinize how we look and how we might be perceived these images didn't demand perfection; they simply existed.

As someone born in the late 2000s, I recognize this same longing in my generation for the aesthetic of the Y2K era. The nostalgic quality of a digital camera evokes something subtly iconic a glowing haziness that only lower-quality photos seem able to create. However, I don't think this revitalization is solely about aesthetics. For Shreem Chakravarti '29, a student majoring in fashion design and management in the College of Human Ecology who works with Cornell's


Pioneer
AUDIOTURBO
NO NO

Thread Magazine, the return to the digital camera reflects a shift in the photographer's intention. Chakravarti explained, "I think the digital photos become more intentional and have a direction behind them, no matter the level of the photographer." Since we use our phones for everything, she added, "that detracts from the feeling of taking the photo," turning what could be deliberate into something routine. She also connected the trend to digital exhaustion the mental strain of constant screen use and a desire to detach memory from performance. She explained, "There's a desire to have candid, authentic photos that feel more connected to the moment." The appeal may also be tied to the memories many students grew up with. Chakravarti stated, "We see our old baby photos and our parents' pictures taken on an older digital camera … that 'look' is associated with a nice memory."

Her reflection echoes my own experience flipping through my mother's photo albums the imperfect aesthetic becomes inseparable from the feeling of the memory itself. As someone working in fashion and visual media, Chakravarti sees this nostalgia reflected in how students curate their images, adding, "Phone cameras are so high quality that it doesn't always feel real to the eye. The way we view memories is more closely aligned with the grainy quality of an old camera."

In creative spaces that are increasingly being reshaped by artificial intelligence, imperfection is more vital than ever. Chakravarti explained, "It makes the photos feel more human." Even technically phone cameras often use a wider focal length than the human eye naturally sees. Many digital cameras more closely mirror our perspective, which may help explain why their images feel more aligned with memory than the hyper-clarity of our phones. Her perspective reinforces what I've felt around Cornell's campus: students are not simply chasing an aesthetic. They're longing for photographs that feel intentional and rooted in memory.

We've grown accustomed to posing, to finding our 'good side,' to repeating the same smile in every solo





or group photo we take on our phones. Taking a photo often feels inseparable from the question of how it will be received by online viewership. Will it be posted? Will it be liked? Will it be edited first? Using a digital camera feels different. It invites candor. It captures something raw and unposed, something taken without the immediate instinct to crop, filter or adjust. A camera reverts back to its original intention: a tool for documenting moments rather than performing them.

Chakravarti believes that the shift in intention changes how people behave in front of the cameras as well, explaining, "If the intention of the image is just for the photographer's enjoyment, people become more creative and free." She continued, "It is more fun when you take photos creatively and purely. … photos can capture magic in the scenery around." I've noticed this difference myself. When a photo isn't destined for Instagram or immediate perception, the pressure dissolves.

People stop rehearsing their expressions; the camera becomes less about documentation for others and more about presence for ourselves.

That shift is what makes the photograph feel alive. Amid social media fatigue, Cornell students' return to older cameras feels less like a passing trend and more like a comeback to pure candidness. A digital camera invites intention; it exists simply to preserve a moment. A phone's built-in audience carries expectations that can make even meaningful experiences feel staged.

Looking through those photo albums and scrapbooks of my mother's youth, I felt something I wanted to hold onto, something I longed to see myself in. I want my own photos to carry that same sense of life being lived fully and honestly. I hope to someday flip through pictures of quiet nights, crowded dorm rooms, trips and ordinary days that felt important enough to document. I want to see unfiltered, candid smiles in every house, social circle and moment worth remembering.

Originally published on Cornellsun.com, March 3, 2026

THE COMEBACK NOBODY SAW COMING

Back to 2000





By Boutayna Chokrane
and Christina Pérez

What comes after Y2K fashion? More Y2K fashion, of course! Picture this: a midriff-baring ribbed tank top paired with camouflage cargo pants, and a Fendi baguette bag nonchalantly slung over the shoulder; frayed denim shorts belted by a chunky round buckle, paired with strappy kitten heels and a Von Dutch trucker hat; a pink velour tracksuit with a Gothic font spelling NASTY in rhinestones across the rear, topped off with a pair of Matrix-style sunglasses. What might sound like fashion relics from a bygone era have been worn all over social media in recent years by many of the biggest models of the moment and it's a style revival that doesn't seem to be disappearing any time soon.

If you were dressing yourself in the early 2000s, you might feel some kind of way about Y2K fashion ruling the runways and the sidewalks once again. But if you weren't? It's entirely understandable that mining the annals of recent fashion history and the vintage shops would hold a certain appeal. For all its kitsch and camp, Y2K fashion is full of some intriguing gems. And anyway, fashion is cyclical. No era is immune to a remix now and again.

Before diving into Y2K fashion, it's helpful to remember what was happening globally from 1999 to the early part of the 2000s. After all, Y2K is the shorthand way to write "the year 2000." If the moniker conveys a certain futuristic brevity, that's somewhat by design it echoes the influence of the burgeoning digital age in the zeitgeist. It was the turn of the millennium and the future was on everyone's mind. The tech advances were rolling out quick. In the year 2000, iPods, hybrid cars, camera, and GPS were introduced; iTunes, Wikipedia, and Xbox came in 2001.

If that sounds cool, it definitely was imagine going from a clunky CD player to a sleek iPod! But the promise of the new millennium also came with its share of existential dread. In fact, in 1999, "Y2K" was mostly associated a specific tech-induced panic related to the potential failure of the computer programs that ran banks, transportation, and power plants worldwide. "The Y2K bug was a computer flaw, or bug, that may have caused problems when dealing with dates beyond December 31, 1999," National Geographic report . "The flaw, faced by computer programmers and users all over the world on January 1, 2000, is also known as the millennium bug." Or, as the news anchors simply called it, "Y2K."

Luckily, the Y2K bug never ultimately resulted in major malfunctions it was fixed just in time. One year later, we saw the terror attacks of September 11, 2001.

Pop culture provided a distraction in the truest sense. Thus, the era was driven by MTV, reality television, talk shows, tabloid magazines, and of course celebrities. Their fashion antics came as quick as the tech: Jennifer Lopez wore her iconic green Versace dress on the Grammy Awards red carpet in 2000; Christina Aguilera wore a skimpy sequined number to the VMA's the same year; Justin Timberlake and Britney Spears followed up the next with head-to-toe matching denim.

The early 2000s was also a time where independent women were paving a sexy new path on shows like Sex and the City and Gilmore Girls; when reality shows like Survivor, America's Next Top Model, and The Simple Life were must-see TV; and when the reality-bending film The Matrix had recently blown our minds. The first iterations of the Harry Potter and The Lord of the Rings film franchises were also released.

The energy of Y2K

Y2K fashion mirrored and responded to the uncertainty, fear, optimism, and novelty of the times with a can't-stop-me-now attitude and a carefree, futuristic-retro vibe. The colors were bright and bold, the textures were metallic and shiny, the silhouettes were skin-baring and curve-hugging. Low-rise jeans, crop tops, and visible g-strings were designed to turn heads. Logomania and It-bags were obsessed over; as were sexy pumps, ballet flats, strappy sandals, and kitten-heeled mules. There were chunky sneakers, pointy-toed boots, and towering platform soles, too.

Of course, the aughts weren't solely about glitz and gaudy glam; It stole references from the 1960s and 1970s, too. These skin-baring styles were the precursor to the later, softer styles of the mid-aughts boho aesthetic, which took a page from the flower children of Laurel Canyon, Haight Ashbury, and the Woodstock. Think: peasant blouses, bolero sweaters, perforated belts, prairie dresses, retro prints, denim skirts, hobo bags, slouchy boots, and skinny scarves. As championed by celebrity stylist Rachel Zoe and worn by the likes of Sienna Miller, Mary Kate and Ashley Olsen, and Nicole Richie, the 2000s boho look was copied near and far especially because it was easy to dupe as long as you knew how to layer.





The Y2K fashion revival

Whether it's ballet flats, dresses over flares, or even the re-emergence of the grande dame of high-low Y2K fashion herself, Paris Hilton (who walked the Versace spring 2023 show), the garish glamour and head-spinning eclecticism of this divisive decade in fashion have become all but inescapable. So, too, have some of the decade's most notorious brands, from the recent revival of Baby Phat to the rebirth of Juicy Couture to the resurgence of the Ugg through modish collaborations with the likes of Feng Chen Wang and Madhappy. Meanwhile, recent years marked the 20-year anniversaries of some of the most influential pop-culture phenomena of Y2K style, from The O.C. to One Tree Hill to That's So Raven. Even better: Some of those show's stars have been enjoying newfound fame once again, Adam Brody in Nobody Wants This, anyone?

So what prompted the re-emergence of Y2K fashion now? Like most current fashion trends, it started bubbling under with a little help from Gen-Z influencers on TikTok, where e-girls with retro hairstyles, beaded chokers, and butterfly clips have been happily dancing to "Mr Brightside" and lamenting that they were "born in the wrong decade." It's also a popular tag on every teenager's favorite resale app, Depop, where it doesn't take much trawling to find Miss Sixty jeans (a brand recently fronted by Bella Hadid), a Blink-182 T-shirt, or a pair of Skechers fetching hundreds of pounds. If this doesn't make you feel old already, the fact that many of them are labelled as "vintage" might.

The nostalgia of Y2K

But it might not just be all about the youths. As it's regularly pointed out, our current era is one of turmoil and uncertainty, too—pandemics, divisive elections, climate crisis, and global conflict which may drive a penchant for nostalgia. "It makes sense that the aughts and Y2K fashion trends, potentially from a time when you were less stressed about the world, are back in the zeitgeist," writer Jillian Wilson recently noted.

As for Y2K's absorption into the upper echelons of fashion, it's perhaps little surprise that Marc Jacobs, one of the industry's most reliable bellwethers was among the first. With his Heaven diffusion, launched in 2020 in collaboration with multi-hyphenate creative Ava Nirui as more accessible counterpart to his mainline collections, Jacobs returned to a number of influences spanning the late '90s and '00s, such as the films of Gregg Araki and the Japanese street style of Shoichi Aoki's Fruits magazine.



"It's very personal to me, because the first designer items that I owned were from Marc by Marc Jacobs. That was like the pinnacle of luxury for me at that time," says Nirui. "This is the first trend that I've actually lived through and that I was a teenager for, so I feel super-connected to all of these vintage brands that are being recirculated,"

Originally published on Vogue.com, January 26, 2025

THE DOOMSDAY



The tension, the myth, and the reality of Y2K.

By: Eric Spitznagel

Twenty years ago, we were all pretty sure the world was going to end on January 1, 2000 or, if not the world, then at least civilization. It had something to do with how most computer programs used the last two digits to represent a four-digit year, and when the clock rolled over at the end of 1999, every computer would think it was 1900. When that happened, ATMs would stop working, the electrical grid would shut down, planes would fall out of the skies, and newborn babies would get hundred-year-old birth certificates. We were legitimately freaked out. And why wouldn't we be? TIME published an ominous cover story with extra exclamation points. President Bill Clinton said not-at-all-reassuring things about Y2K like, "This is not one of the summer movies where you can close your eyes during the scary parts." CNN suggested that readers prepare for Y2K by stockpiling powdered milk, canned juices, and "comfort food." (Note: Tech Armageddon is easier to take with carbs.) Apple produced this TV commercial, which still makes us want to hide under the bed: But then New Year's came and went. We all woke up with electricity. ATMs didn't refuse to dispense cash. Planes remained in the air. The great catastrophic threat of our time turned out to be a colossal dud. So what really happened with Y2K? Was humanity ever actually in danger? Was this tech's Cuban Missile Crisis, or Mayan Doomsday Calendar? To find out the truth, we spoke to the people who witnessed it firsthand: those brave souls who toiled in the IT trenches, surrounded by other underslept programmers, probably while crouched nervously behind a ThinkPad 701 or Bondi Blue iMac.

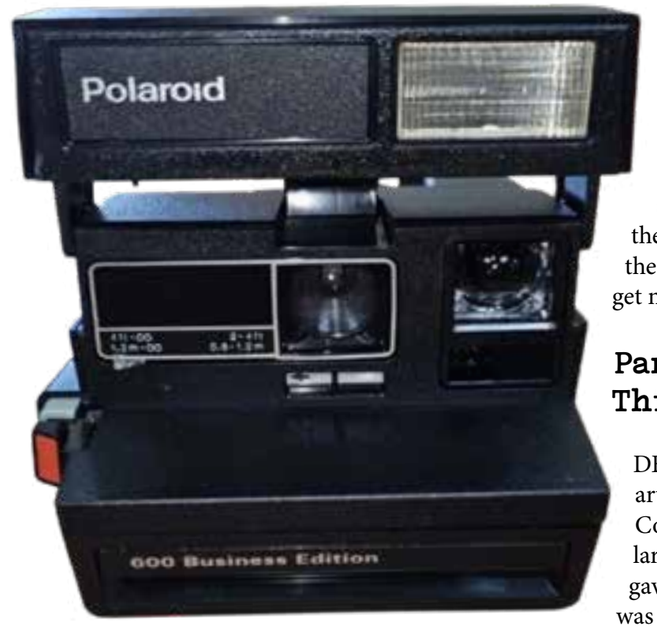
Part I. The Early Warnings

STEVEN M. BELLOVIN (Professor in the Computer Science department at Columbia University): I casually realized that there might be a problem in the late 1960s, but thought nothing of it. I was learning and using [the computer programming language] PL/I around then, and noted the lack of digits for the century. There were similar problems with [the operating system] OS/360. All that said, the fact that I casually noticed two-digit years does not mean that I foresaw the problem I absolutely did not.

PETER DE JAGER (Canadian computer programmer): I realized what would happen in 1978. I was a computer operator for IBM. We managed a system called COLT, which stood for Canadian Online Tellers. One day I noticed that we were typing in just two digits for the year. When we got to 2000, what numbers would I be typing in? Double zeros? And then wouldn't the computer think it was 1900? It meant that any calculation based upon time, which is all financial calculations, would be incorrect. So I went to my boss and said, "We have a problem. The computers out there aren't going to work properly when we hit the year 2000." He looked at me and said, "You're worried about a problem that isn't going to happen for 22 years? Relax, somebody will fix it by then." So I got up and left his office.

"You're worried about a problem that isn't going to happen for 22 years? Relax, somebody will fix it by then."

BELLOVIN: The problem dates back to the pre-computer punch card days. Punch cards for information storage and processing go back to the 1880s. Although there were many different varieties of punch cards from different vendors, the IBM one was the most popular. It had 80 columns; each of which could hold approximately one character. This meant that space was at a premium. Folks used all sorts of tricks to save space planning ahead, and many of the early databases were simply copies of the card images.



CAPERS JONES (former manager and software researcher at IBM): I worked in the IT business since the early '70s. We knew about the Y2K problem at IBM pretty early, but I didn't pay that much attention to it until the '90s. Because it wasn't unique. They were other date-related issues in software.

MARTYN THOMAS (Professor of IT, Gresham College, London; led the Y2K teams for Deloitte Consulting internationally in the 1990s): A British grocery store, I think it was Marks & Spencer, received a delivery of tinned meat in the late 1980s that had a use-by date of 01/00. The goods inward software checked that it was in date, recognized 01/00 as January 1900 and rejected it as already over 80 years old. They reordered, but the replacement had the same problem.

DE JAGER: We get to 1989, and still nobody is working on this problem. I'm at a company that uses an IBM product called PROSS Professional Office Systems. On January 1, 1990, the system goes haywire. Why? They're using a one-digit year in their system, so when it went from 89 to 90, it went back to zero again and messed everything up. Out of curiosity, I went to my personal computer and set the date to December 31, 1999, just a few minutes before midnight. I powered off the computer and waited 10 minutes. Then I fired up the computer and looked at the time. It said the date was 1984. That's when I began to get nervous.

Part II. Something Wicked This Way Comes

DE JAGER: In 1993, I wrote an article about the Y2K problem for Computerworld magazine, which was the largest IT magazine in the world. They gave it the title "Doomsday 2000" and it was the article that got everyone's attention. "Our information systems are based on a faulty standard that will cost the worldwide computer community billions of dollars. We and our computers were supposed to make life easier. What we have delivered is a catastrophe." From that point until 2000, Y2K was the only thing I did. It became my full-time job.

CLIFFORD STOLL (Berkeley astronomer, author, and vocal Y2K critic): Y2K? Oh my, I



haven't thought about that debacle in years. So much ado about nothing. Don't get me started. In the beginning, I was laughed at. I was called a farce and a jokester. But when they realized I was right, that the danger was real, I became the fear monger. Y2K was easily described, easily understood, and easily blown out of proportion. I meet people at the grocery store well, the Berkeley Bowl who hoped that all computers would melt down, and we would somehow be transported back to a wonderland of pre-technology.



WILLIAM PINSON (former employer of a hardware provider for the oil & gas industry, which he declines to name): My division handled instrumentation and controls for the drilling process, as well as industrial products for the shipping industry and the U.S. Navy. I was tasked to lead the Y2K software and firmware upgrade kit effort for the company. I don't recall when or how I first learned about Y2K, but it was probably the same as everybody else. The hype in the media, both mainstream and otherwise, and an array of "gloom and doom" advertisements by companies trying to cash in on the hysteria. "In the beginning, I was laughed at. I was called a farce and a jokester. But when they realized I was right, that the danger was real, I became the fear monger."

DAVID JEFFRIES (VP of Development at IBM): Y2K kind of cropped up in '95. We started noticing the growth of a separate group that started showing up at meetings. They were like, "We're the Y2K engineers" or "We're the Y2K project program analysts." The rest of us would look around at each other and go, "Y2K? What's that?"

TOM ATLEE (co-founder and research director of the Co-Intelligence Institute, and co-editor of Awakening: The Upside of Y2K): In March of 1998, a Silicon Valley tech manager who was on the board of my small nonprofit asked me, "Tom, what do you know about the systemic effects of Y2K?" I responded, "I don't have to worry. I have a Mac."

Originally published on PopularMechanics.com, December 27, 2019



Live VIEW!

MODE MODE MODE MODE

Interfaces, pixels, and digital displays influence not just what we see, but how we understand and remember images.

FRAMED BY THE SCREEN

By: Kei Bodkhs

In an era of retro meets hypermodern, there is a definite look coming back from the beginning of the millennium and it's succeeding very well. Frutiger Aero, Y2K futurism, and Y2K cybercore are more than just retro echoes. They're visions of the future of the past, and their comeback are telling us that optimism, minimal design, and a little bit of techno-anarchy can actually feel very fresh. frutiger aero is an entire look. Based on the Frutiger typeface and paired with Microsoft's clean, rounded minimalism of its Aero user interface (i.e., Windows Vista), Frutiger Aero was the early 2000s look. It's that shiny, über-sanitized style that dominated UI/UX design, advertising, corporate identity, and even product packaging. Picture it: soft gradients, transparent glows, drop shadows, glass reflections, leaf patterns, and blue-sky backgrounds complete with floating bubbles. This style is rooted in a hopeful, eco-tech optimism that defined 2000s branding where technology was sleek, helpful, and futuristic, not dystopian. It's the look of default Windows wallpapers, Nokia promotional materials, and airline websites from 2003. It says

"the future is clean, and you'll be there with one click."



Now, bring that vision to the frenzied underground Y2K cybercore. Cybercore is a grittier, edgier, DIY approach than Frutiger Aero's corporate gloss. Cybercore draws internet angst, sci-fi dystopia, techno-tribalism, and early web graphics to make a rich, glitchy paste of chrome textures, twisted 3D shapes, alien hieroglyphics, and blue-toxic color. Imagine your old family computer infested with a dozen viruses but somehow coming to life and gaining style. Y2K cybercore thrives in fashion (think metallic fabrics, wraparound sunglasses, exposed wires), graphic design (3d futuristic fonts, gloss, colorfull chrome), and music (breakcore, hyperpop, etc.). It's messy but intentional techwear meets rave flyer energy. Where Frutiger Aero tried to make the internet friendly, cybercore embraces its alienness and leans all the way in. ying it all together is Y2K futurism, a broad cultural aesthetic that spans architecture, fashion, tech, and media. It's the world imagined by people in the late '90s and early 2000s who really believed that, by 2020, we'd all be living in glass-domed cities, communicating via holograms, and flying around in autonomous pods.

It's the iPod silhouettes universe, The Matrix, Minority Report, and Jetsons-at-the-core. Y2K futurism was flashy and bold, but also that hint of techno-terror. It's an expression of a certain kind of optimism that technology could save humanity without consuming us in one big gulp a flash drive utopia. You see it in concept cars with LED headlights and no steering wheels, in retro Palm Pilot ads, in the Space Age revival surreal optimism. It's so ironic, so genuine, and it hits today's web users like a shimmering wave of "what if?". Frutiger Aero, Y2K cybercore, and Y2K futurism aren't merely design trends they're emotional time capsules. They're the thrill of embarking into a digital age, a connected world, and the disquieting, half-ironic longing for a future that had seemed slick and full of promise.

Now, in an era where our digital life is more substantial than reality, we're looking back not to escape, but to re-envision. We're salvaging the visual dreams of yesteryear to create something new, future nostalgia with a pixelated smile and a transparent sheen. And for real? That's awesome.

Originally published on Medium.com, April 5, 2025








IDLE
IDLE
IDLE

DEADLINE